

By AL MALLETT

Kip Horsburgh and Carl Fazio still maintain their motto "100,000 or Bust" for Elmira Pioneer baseball 1972 but the goal now may be just a bit out of reach.

Elmira has had four plus-100,000 gate seasons and a bit of research points to two distinct ingredients needed to cash in 100,000— excellent spring weather plus exciting players.

Elmira 1972 hasn't had the spring weather and with so many rainouts, no one has been able to establish himself as an exciting player.

Elmira's first 100,000-plus gate season was 1939 — a very unusual year, weather-wise.

The Pioneers didn't have a rainout the first 23 games (the season opener was played in a drizzle) and they had such sparklers as Pete Reiser (who later injured his arm), George Staller, John Hvidsos and Bill McWilliams.

Of course, you must remember, too, that all 1939 games up to mid-June were played in the afternoon when it's Decidedly warmer than it is at night and more conducive to playing, sitting and watching.

Elmira attracted 124,383 in 1941 — and again the Pioneers had fantastically fine weather in the spring, only two rainouts from season-opening day, April 23, through Memorial Day, May 30.

That year, too, Johnny Ogden had some real heroes in Elmira uniforms — like Eddie Robinson, Andy Cohen, Franke Madura, Eddie Kobesky, Sal Maglie and Ray Roche.

War year 1943 saw more good spring weather plus such crowd-pleasers as Alex Mustaikis, Sad Sam Zoldak, Ed Busch, Don Smith and Les Moss.

Spence Harris began 1951 with an Art Fabbro one-hitter before more than 5,000 opening night fans — and the fans never stopped coming as an all-time record 126,238 paraded through the Dunn Field gates to watch Don Zimmer, Bill Boudreau, Gale Wade, Nap Peeples, Bob Wilson and Ed Roebuck.

Elmira hasn't hit the 100,000 gate figure since and the miserable weather (who can remember when we've had a worse first three weeks of baseball?) this year has put a serious roadblock in the path of Horsburgh-

Fazio and their goal.

But the baseball "Whiz Kids" are carrying on, keeping enthusiasm high and dreaming up new gimmicks and promotions to lure fans out to Dunn.

They may be dreaming the impossible dream, but at least they're not sitting in a corner sulking like a couple of their predecessors.

Oh yes, there are a few other items Kip and Carl have to contend with that were not prevalent in those old 100,000 gate days—like television, Little League, Small Fry, Babe Ruth, boats, the golf explosion, backyard swimming pools and barbeques among all the other attractions available today for the entertainment and participation buck.

TODAY'S TRIVIA question: Which brother team won the most major league baseball games in their careers? . . . The Triple Cities Jets have contracted to play at least one 1972 semi-pro football game in Sayre . . . It's official, the Broome-Tioga-Chemung Bengals will play three games at Notre Dame Stadium this season — July 29 vs. Maryland Saints, Aug. 5 vs. Rochester Warriors and Oct. 22 vs. New Jersey Red Oaks. The July 29 and Aug. games will start at 8, the Oct. 22 game at 12:30 p.m. . . Tuesday's Horseheads at Notre Dame track meet could decide the 1972 Sullivan Trail championship.

JIM EISENMAN'S sudden death leaves a huge void in the local sports picture. The ex-Navy football great (1945-46-47) was one of the area's big sports boosters . . . Gary Girmindl received a trophy from an admirer following the Arnold Palmer match engraved thusly: "Gary Girmindl, one of the few who can boast that he belongs to the elite 'I never lost to Arnold Palmer' Club." . . . Heck, Gee Gee, I can boast that myself . . In answer to a question: **Bill Sharman** was an Elmira Pioneer outfielder for 10 games in August, 1950. He hit .289 . . . Answer to the trivia question: No it wasn't the **Deans, Diz and Daffy**, who won 200 between them. Nor is it the **Perrys, Gaylond and Jim**, who have 304. It's the **Mathewsons, Christy and Henry**, who won 367 between them — with all 367 credited to Christy. Henry had an 0-1 major league mark. This tricky question may fade before long . . . if the Perrys keep winning.